

what is meant by intrinsic size?

Intrinsic size means: an element's "natural" size based on its **own content**, not because you forced a width/height in CSS.

Think: *"If I don't set any size, how big does this thing want to be by itself?"*

Easy examples

1) Image intrinsic size

An image file has a real pixel size (like 800x600). That's its intrinsic size.

html

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```

```

css

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```
img {
  /* no width/height set */
}
```

➡️ The browser will show it at its natural size (or fit it depending on layout rules).

2) Text intrinsic size (a `span`)

A `span` is as wide as its text. That width is intrinsic.

html

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```
<span class="tag">Hello World</span>
```

css

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```
.tag {
  border: 1px solid black;
  /* no width set */
}
```

➡️ The border wraps tightly around "Hello World". That "tight wrap" width is the intrinsic size.

3) Button intrinsic size

Buttons usually size themselves based on the label text + padding.

html

```
<button class="btn">Click me</button>
```

css

```
.btn {  
  padding: 10px 16px;  
  /* no width set */  
}
```

➡ The button grows/shrinks based on the text. That’s intrinsic sizing.

Intrinsic sizing keywords you’ll see in CSS

You may see these values in CSS (especially for width/height):

- `max-content` → as wide as the content wants (no wrapping)
- `min-content` → smallest width that still fits (wrap as much as possible)
- `fit-content` → “as big as needed but not too big” (clamped)

Example:

css

```
.box {  
  width: max-content;  
}
```

One-line summary

Intrinsic size = the size the element naturally takes from its content (text/image/etc.) when you don’t force a size.

If you want, tell me where you saw “intrinsic size” (Flexbox? Grid? images?) and I’ll explain it in that exact context with a small code demo.

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